Becoming a Man

What was your idea of what it means to be a man when you were growing up?

Mine was that when I could live independently of my parents, I would be a man. You may have your own idea of what it means to be a man. Whatever you thought it was when you were younger reveals a pattern that was set up in your life to confuse you from becoming the man that God planned for you.

In a genuine sense, we are faced with the same dilemma that the Israelites faced in Daniel 3. Before we go there, let's remember what Paul said in Romans 12:2, "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind." Whatever ideas you have in your mind about what being a man truly is, I ask that you suspend those thoughts to grasp what God is showing us in the Scriptures.

In Daniel 3, King Nebuchadnezzar set up a 90-foot golden image of a man; presumably, it was his image. He commanded that everyone bow down to the image. If not, they would be thrown into a fiery furnace and die. You have to do this; you have no choice. That is the world talking...to you. The world is telling you what a man is, and so you follow... But wait!

Suddenly, off in the distance, there are 3 men who refuse to bow to the image! They refuse to worship an image, but to worship only the True God of Israel.

Have you bowed to the ideas and concepts of the world as to what it means to be a man, or are you willing to stand on the Truth from God's Word?

I Cor. 14:20 says, "Brothers, don't be little boys in your understanding... but in your understanding, be mature men."

What does being a mature man look like? Again, let's go to Scripture: I Cor. 11:1 NASB. "Be imitators of me, just as I also am of Christ."

Can you say that to your kids? How about your wife? Or what about those you work with?

This causes us to consider how we can grow in our relationship with Christ so that our lives will resemble His. That is what becoming a man really is.